

Luiss

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Branching

Introduction to Computer Programming

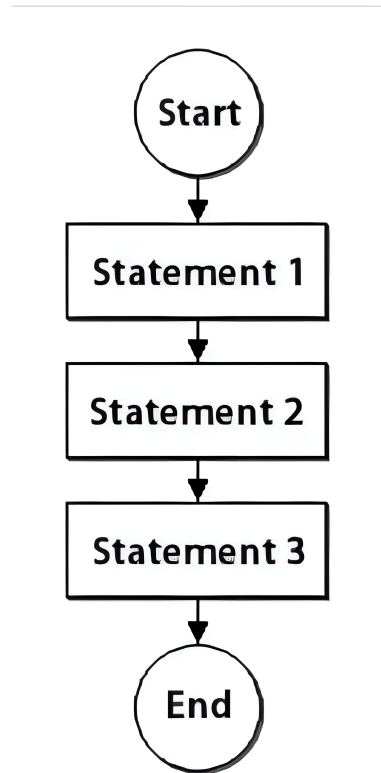
Management and Artificial Intelligence

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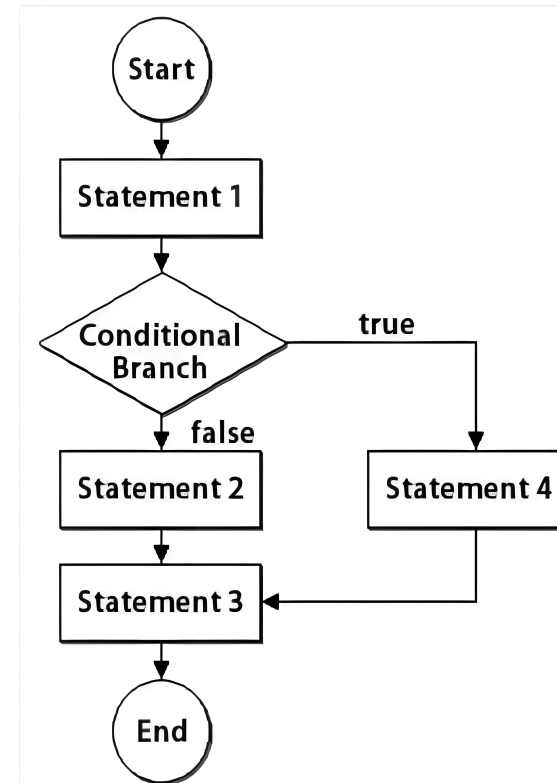


Branching

A program **without branching**



A program **with branching**



Branching in Python

Plain if

```
if <condition>:  
    statement  
    statement  
    ...
```

if-else

```
if <condition>:  
    statement  
    ...  
else:  
    statement  
    ...
```

if-elif-else

```
if <condition>:  
    statement  
    ...  
elif <condition>:  
    statement  
    ...  
else:  
    statement  
    ...
```

- <condition> yields True or False
- Evaluate statements in that block if <condition> is True
- Indentation is the key to delimit blocks
- Place : at the end of <condition>

Examples: if

```
num = 3
if num > 0:
    print(num, "is a positive number.")
print("This is always printed. It's outside of the block.")
```

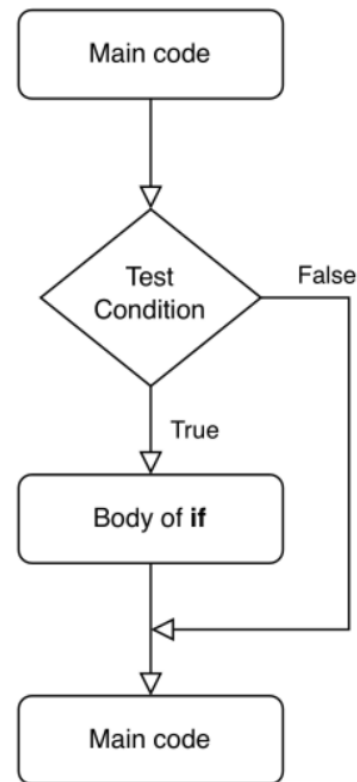
3 is a positive number.
This is always printed. It's outside of the block.

```
num = -1
if num > 0:
    print(num, "is a positive number.")
print("This is always printed. It's outside of the block.")
```

This is always printed. It's outside of the block.

Flowchart of an `if` statement

Logical flowchart of an if statement:



Examples: if-else

```
num = 1
if num >= 0:
    print("Number is positive or zero.")
else:
    print("Negative number.")
```

Number is positive or zero.

What happens with:

- num = 0
- num = -5

?

```
num = 0
if num >= 0:
    print("Number is positive or zero.")
else:
    print("Negative number.")
```

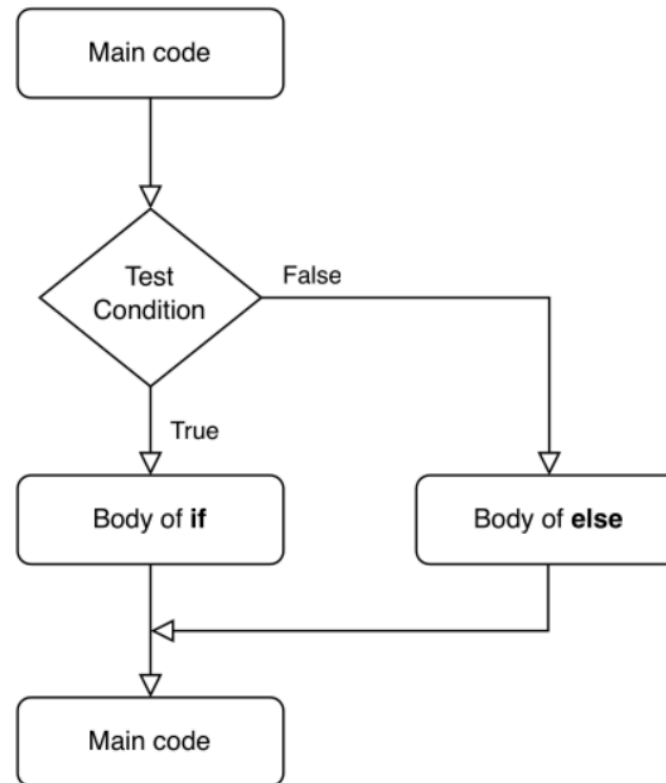
Number is positive or zero.

```
num = -5
if num >= 0:
    print("Number is positive or zero.")
else:
    print("Negative number.")
```

Negative number.

Flowchart of an `if-else` statement

Logical flowchart of an if-else statement.:



Examples: if-elif-else

```
num = 3.4
if num > 0:
    print("Number is positive.")
elif num == 0:
    print("Number is zero.")
else:
    print("Number is negative.")
```

Number is positive.

What happens with:

- num = 0
- num = -4.5

?

```
num = 0
if num > 0:
    print("Number is positive.")
elif num == 0:
    print("Number is zero.")
else:
    print("Number is negative.")
```

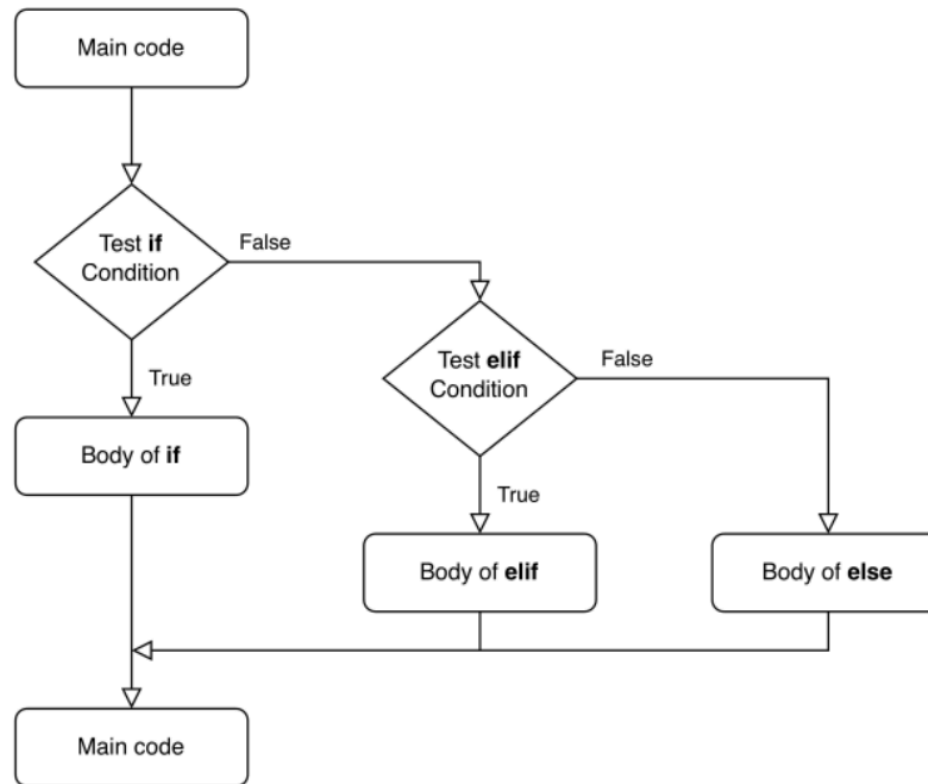
Number is zero.

```
num = -4.5
if num > 0:
    print("Number is positive.")
elif num == 0:
    print("Number is zero.")
else:
    print("Number is negative.")
```

Number is negative.

Flowchart of an `if-elif-else` statement

Logical flowchart of an if-elif-else statement:



Nested Statements

Branching statements `if`, `else` and `elif` can be nested arbitrarily.

```
num = 10
# or interactive:
# num = float(input()) # recall: input() returns a string
print("You entered: ", num)
if num >= 0:
    if num == 0:
        print("Number is zero")
    else:
        print("Number is positive")
else:
    print("Number is negative")
```

```
You entered: 10
Number is positive
```

Indentation

RECALL: Indentation (tab or 4 spaces) delimits blocks of code in Python.

```
x = 10.0 #float(input("Enter a value for x: "))
y = 20.0 #float(input("Enter a value for y: "))
print("x is", x)
print("y is", y)
if x == y:
    print("y and x are equal")
    if y != 0:
        print("Finally, x/y is", x / y)
elif x > y:
    print("y is smaller")
else:
    print("x is smaller")
```

```
x is 10.0
y is 20.0
x is smaller
```

Warm-up Exercises

- [Notebook with exercises on branching \(no hints\)](#)
- [Notebook with exercises on branching \(with pseudocode\)](#)
- [Notebook with exercises on branching \(with solutions\)](#)

